

ZEPTO CAFE

Step 1: Market & User Research

Building Repeat Food Ordering Habit — Primary Research Report

Research Objective

Understand why office snack-break users try Zepto Cafe but do not return for a second order.
Goal: Identify the primary barriers to repeat ordering and validate or refute initial hypotheses.
Case Study Target: Increase 30-day repeat order rate from 12% → 25% in 6 months.

21	15	7	6
Total Responses	Valid (Office / Hybrid)	Used Zepto Cafe	Cities Represented

Cities: Bengaluru · Delhi/NCR · Hyderabad · Pune · Mumbai · Ahmedabad
Age bands: 22–27 and 28–34 (primary respondent group)
Screener applied: Remote workers filtered out (6 removed). Only office-going and hybrid workers included.

1. Existing Snack Habits — What Zepto Cafe Competes Against

Before fixing repeat ordering, we must understand the entrenched behavior Zepto Cafe is competing with. When office workers are hungry, they don't think 'which app should I use?' — they follow a habit loop.

Behavior	Respondents	% of Valid
Step out to a nearby stall or café	11 / 15	73%
Go to the office canteen / cafeteria	9 / 15	60%
Order from a food delivery app (Swiggy, Zomato)	8 / 15	53%
Order from a quick-commerce app (Zepto, Blinkit)	8 / 15	53%
Eat something brought from home	4 / 15	27%
Ask a colleague to bring something	2 / 15	13%
Skip and wait for the next meal	1 / 15	7%

Key Insight

Zepto Cafe's primary competitor is NOT Swiggy or Zomato.

It is the chai wala downstairs and the office canteen — both of which are free or subsidised for many users.

73% of respondents step outside. For a delivery app to win this moment, it must deliver something the stall or canteen cannot: freshness + convenience together.

2. What Triggers the Ordering Moment

Understanding the trigger is critical — product features must hook into the right moment, not just exist in the app.

Trigger	Respondents	% of Valid
Hunger between meals	8 / 15	53%
When a colleague orders and I join in	6 / 15	40%
Chai / coffee craving	5 / 15	33%
A specific time of day (e.g., 4pm snack break)	5 / 15	33%
Stress or needing a mental break	4 / 15	27%
When I see a discount or offer notification	3 / 15	20%

PM Implication

Discounts rank LAST as a trigger (20%) — validating the case study constraint of not relying on discounts.

The top two triggers (hunger + colleague ordering) are social and habitual. Product features should hook into these: e.g., group ordering, time-of-day push nudges at 4pm.

3. What Users Value When Choosing Where to Order

Ratings on a 1–5 scale. n=15 valid respondents.

Factor	Importance Score	Avg / 5
Ease of ordering		4.67/5
Food quality / freshness		4.6/5
Reliability (right order, right time)		4.53/5
Speed of delivery		4.4/5
Price / value for money		4.07/5

4. Zepto Cafe — Awareness, Usage & Experience

4a. Awareness & Usage Split

7 / 15	4 / 15	4 / 15
47%	27%	27%
Have Used Zepto Cafe	Heard of it, never tried	Never heard of it

Key finding: Trial is not the problem — 47% of office workers in our sample have already tried Zepto Cafe. The problem is repeat. Of the 7 who tried, most ordered only 1–2 times in 30 days, well below the cadence needed to build a habit.

4b. Zepto Cafe Experience Ratings (n=7 users)

How did the experience actually feel vs. what users said they need?

Experience Dimension	Zepto Score	Score vs User Need
Delivery Speed		4.57/5 (users expect: 4.4/5)
Value for Money		4/5 (users expect: 4.07/5)
Order Accuracy		3.71/5 (users expect: 4.53/5)
Food Freshness		3.71/5 (users expect: 4.6/5)
Food Taste		3.57/5

The Critical Gap

SPEED: Zepto delivers here — 4.57/5, comfortably above user expectation (4.40). This is the product's core strength.

QUALITY: Food taste (3.57) and freshness (3.71) significantly underperform against user priority (4.60 for quality).

ACCURACY: Order accuracy (3.71) also lags far behind user expectation (4.53). Wrong or missing items destroy trust.

→ Zepto Cafe wins on the promise (speed) but loses on the delivery (taste + freshness + accuracy).

5. Why Users Don't Come Back — Drop-off Analysis

5a. Stated Reasons for Not Reordering (n=7 Zepto users)

Drop-off Reason	Count	Priority
Prefer another app / existing habit	3	HIGH
Food quality wasn't good enough to try again	2	HIGH
Bad experience — late delivery / wrong order	2	HIGH
Forgot about it / no trigger to return	1	MEDIUM

5b. What Would Drive Repeat Ordering (User Responses)

Feature / Fix Requested	Times Mentioned
Better food quality / freshness guarantee	5
Personalized recommendations based on past orders	4
Reminders at my usual snack time	4
Reorder in one tap for my favourites	3
Subscription or loyalty pass	2
Lower prices / better value	2

6. Voice of the User — Verbatim Quotes

These direct quotes should be treated as the north star for the product strategy.

"Samosa is mostly not fresh. Even cupcakes suffer quality issues. I'd rather have more options."

— Office worker, Delhi/NCR — lapsed Zepto Cafe user

"Once ordered, Zepto should make sure they deliver the item instead of refunding money without any apologies. Item availability is the real issue."

— Office worker, Bengaluru — lapsed Zepto Cafe user

"Users expect food to be fresh, have multiple food options, and to be delivered quickly."

— Hybrid worker, Pune — first-time user

"Food delivery delay without any communication has been a really annoying experience for me."

— Hybrid worker, Pune — lapsed user

"The idea of Zepto Cafe sounds good but it needs to be more promising so that I prefer it over a standard canteen food item."

— Office worker, Delhi/NCR — aware but hesitant

"It should know when I want to eat and give me healthy daily options."

— Office worker, Hyderabad — non-user expressing ideal state

7. User Personas

Three personas emerged from the data, each representing a distinct relationship with office snacking and Zepto Cafe.



PERSONA 1

The Canteen Loyalist

~40% of sample

Profile: Full-time office worker, 28–35 years, large enterprise, subsidised canteen.

Behavior: Goes to canteen out of habit. Has tried Zepto Cafe once (prompted by discount or colleague). Didn't return.

Barrier: Canteen is free or nearly free. Zepto Cafe must deliver noticeably better quality to justify cost.

Hook: Quality signal + freshness guarantee. "Better than canteen" is the job-to-be-done.



PERSONA 2

The App Experimenter

~33% of sample

Profile: Hybrid worker, 22–30 years, startup or mid-size company, no canteen or pays full price.

Behavior: Regular Swiggy/Zomato user. Tried Zepto Cafe 1–2 times. Reverted to Zomato due to quality or habit pull.

Barrier: Swiggy/Zomato are deeply habitual. Zepto Cafe needs a compelling differentiation — speed alone is not enough.

Hook: One-tap reorder of favourites + personalized 4pm nudge. Reduce friction to re-engage.



PERSONA 3

The Colleague Follower

~27% of sample

Profile: Office worker of any age. Has heard of Zepto Cafe but never ordered independently.

Behavior: Orders when a colleague suggests it. Has no personal snacking habit via app. Steps out to nearby stall by default.

Barrier: Low trust in grocery app for food. No personal motivation to try. "What if it's bad?" is the default thought.

Hook: Social proof, ratings, and a risk-free first experience. Group ordering feature could convert this cohort at scale.

8. Summary of Repeat Ordering Barriers

Ranked by frequency and impact based on survey data and open-text responses.

#	Barrier	Frequency	Impact
1	Food quality & freshness gap — Zepto scores 3.57–3.71/5 on taste and freshness; users expect 4.60/5	High	Very High
2	Habit inertia — canteen, chai wala, and nearby stalls are zero-effort default behaviors for 60–73% of users	High	High
3	Trust deficit — 'grocery app' perception makes users skeptical about food quality before they even try	Medium	High
4	No recovery mechanism — bad experience (wrong order, no apology, refund only) = permanent churn	Medium	Very High
5	Awareness gap — 27% of valid office respondents have never heard of Zepto Cafe doing food	Medium	Medium
6	No habit hook — no trigger to return after first order; app doesn't remind or personalise for the user	Low	High

9. Research Conclusion — Setting Up Step 2

The Core Finding

Trial is happening. 47% of office workers in our sample have tried Zepto Cafe.

But the experience doesn't meet expectations: Zepto scores 3.57–3.71/5 on what users care about most (quality: 4.60/5).

The repeat ordering problem is NOT primarily an awareness problem or a pricing problem.

It is a quality-trust-habit problem: users try once, experience a gap, and default back to their existing behavior.

The hypothesis 'habit & awareness' is PARTIALLY correct — awareness is a secondary barrier (27% never heard of it).

But the PRIMARY barrier is: the first experience doesn't earn a second visit.

What Step 2 Must Frame

- Why does the first experience fail to earn a second order? (quality + accuracy gap)
- What is the specific product-level fix that addresses this without touching kitchen operations?
- Which of the 6 barriers has the highest leverage — and which can a PM actually solve in-app?
- What is the primary barrier statement that will guide all solution ideation in Step 3?